

THE WORLD

Master Design Bible

A browser-first magical universe for curiosity, adventure and kindness



North star

Create the place a child cannot wait to return to - a magical world first, with good values woven quietly into the adventure.

MASTER EDITION 1.0 | JULY 2026

DOCUMENT GUIDE

How to Use This Bible

The permanent source of truth for world design, production decisions and future phase briefs.

This master PDF defines what The World is, what it is not, how its systems fit together, and the order in which it should be built. It is intentionally broader than a normal game design document. It combines creative direction, product strategy, child-safety principles, technical architecture, content-production rules and a phased roadmap.

Cursor should use this document as context, but should receive a separate detailed PDF for each production phase. The phase PDFs will expand every screen, state, interaction, image prompt, data requirement and acceptance test. The master prevents those later prompts from drifting away from the original vision.

- **For creative work:** Use the world principles, art direction, lore rules and character-writing standards.
- **For coding work:** Use the technical architecture, reusable content model, state rules and phase gates.
- **For image generation:** Use the visual consistency contract and asset prompt templates before generating any scene.
- **For scope decisions:** If a requested feature conflicts with the player promise or child-safety rules, the bible wins.
- **For future phase PDFs:** Use the standard phase-document structure in the final appendix.

Important

The World must never be described publicly as a “Neopets clone.” Its structure may use illustrated click-through locations, but its identity is a cosmic storybook universe built around wonder, kindness, secrets, companions and optional real-world family participation.

NAVIGATION

Contents

The master is organised from vision to systems to execution.

Section	Focus
1	Vision and player promise
2	Audience, values and safety
3	The universe and its places
4	Core gameplay and progression
5	Family and real-world systems
6	Art, interface and content production
7	Technology, data and operations
8	Master production roadmap
9	Phase specifications 0-11
10	Cursor production contract and appendices

Future detailed phase PDFs should keep the same terminology used here. Avoid renaming major systems casually: Explorer, Companion, Crossroads, Home Quests, Starlight, The Between and Heartstar are working terms that provide internal consistency until formally replaced.

SECTION 01

Vision and Player Promise

Define the feeling before defining the features.

CORE CONCEPT

The One-Sentence Concept

The World is a vast magical universe that respects children, rewards curiosity and quietly encourages them to become good people.

Players become Wayfinders: young explorers who can see paths between strange realms that most inhabitants cannot. They travel with an original magical companion, build a personal home, collect meaningful objects, play games, help memorable characters and slowly uncover a cosmic mystery that is never completely explained.

The experience is browser-first and primarily built from richly illustrated clickable locations. Some pictures can be “entered” as mini-games, battles or small walkable areas. This keeps the world visually rich and expandable without requiring one enormous continuous 3D map.

Emotional benchmark

The player should feel the way a child feels when a story suddenly opens a door into another reality: safe enough to stay, curious enough to keep clicking, and certain that something wonderful might be hidden just beyond the obvious path.

What it is	What it is not
• A magical place to escape into for minutes or hours • A storybook universe with games and persistent progress • A private, low-pressure experience without open chat • A world that changes with seasons, events and discoveries • A family-positive game without becoming a parenting app	• A classroom wearing fantasy clothes • A pay-to-win economy • An open social network for children • A grim combat MMO • A flat collection of unrelated mini-games • A direct copy of a nostalgic browser game

NORTH-STAR RULES

The Player Promise

Every major decision should preserve these six promises.

Wonder before optimisation

The world should contain things that exist because they are delightful, not because they maximise engagement.

Magic before education

Values and habits are embedded in stories and choices. The interface must never feel like homework.

Safety without sterility

Remove open chat and harmful systems, but do not make the world bland, over-explained or infantilising.

Curiosity is rewarded

Odd clicks, return visits, patient observation and unusual choices should sometimes reveal something meaningful.

Free players belong

The main adventure, stories, games and core progression remain genuinely accessible without payment.

The world remembers

NPC reactions, small environmental changes and long-term collections should make a player feel that their journey matters.

EMOTIONAL DESIGN

The Desired Feeling

The experience should feel more like entering a beloved book than opening an app.

- **On first visit:** “I want to go down there.”
- **After ten minutes:** “There is more here than I expected.”
- **After the first session:** “I want to see what happens tomorrow.”
- **After one month:** “This is my explorer, my companion and my little corner of the world.”
- **After one year:** “I remember when that door was still sealed.”
- **As an adult remembering it:** “That place genuinely mattered to me.”

The strongest competitor is not another game. It is every short-form feed, noisy multiplayer lobby and disposable mobile reward loop. The World differentiates itself by being calm enough to inhabit, deep enough to explore and strange enough to remember.

Design test

When evaluating a feature, ask: does this deepen wonder, personal ownership, meaningful progress or safe curiosity? If it only increases clicks or monetisation pressure, it probably does not belong.

DECISION FRAMEWORK

Core Product Principles

A compact operating constitution for design and development.

Principle	Practical implication
Illustrated depth over empty scale	Fifty highly interactive scenes are more valuable than a huge walkable world filled with nothing.
Small stories over constant apocalypse	Helping a baker, returning a letter or comforting a frightened creature can matter more than saving the universe every week.
No humiliation loops	Failure should create humour, learning or another path - not public embarrassment or loss designed to provoke spending.
Collecting with meaning	Items should connect to places, characters, events or memories rather than existing as meaningless numerical clutter.
Optional family connection	Parents can participate privately through approvals and celebrations, but the child's fantasy experience remains independent.
Expandable by templates	Every town, shop, NPC, quest and event should be created from reusable systems so the world can grow for years.

SECTION 02

Audience, Values and Safety

Respect children without underestimating them.

PLAYER MODEL

Audience and Age Adaptation

One world, with writing and guidance adjusted by broad age bracket.

Players choose a broad path rather than entering an exact birthday. The underlying locations, major stories and rewards remain shared so siblings can talk about the same world. Dialogue complexity, hints, reading length, emotional nuance and guardian controls adapt behind the scenes.

Age bracket	In-world name	Adaptation
6-8	Bright Path	Shorter dialogue, clearer choices, visible guidance, simple emotional language, forgiving games.
9-12	Curious Path	More mystery, layered characters, indirect clues, moderate reading, greater exploration freedom.
13-16	Far Path	Longer stories, thoughtful dilemmas, subtle themes, deeper lore, more complex strategy and economy.

Shared-world rule

Age adaptation must not create a “baby version” and a “real version.” All paths should feel dignified, magical and complete. Older writing is more nuanced, not more violent or cynical.

- Do not collect unnecessary personal data.
- Never ask a child to publicly display age, school, location or legal name.
- Parents should be able to revise the bracket without deleting progress.
- Generated dialogue must be curated; do not dynamically improvise sensitive advice to children.

NARRATIVE PHILOSOPHY

Values Without Lectures

The child should experience the consequence of kindness, not receive a morality score.

The World can teach empathy, honesty, courage, patience, boundaries, inclusion, critical thinking and care for others. These values should emerge from satisfying stories, interesting choices and characters who feel real. The game must not pause to explain that the child has “demonstrated empathy.”

Good implementation

- A lonely NPC remembers that the player returned
- An angry creature can be calmed by noticing what frightened it
- Admitting a mistake opens a repair quest
- A disabled character is competent and has their own goals
- A rumour changes depending on who repeats it
- Helping without a reward sometimes creates a later surprise

Bad implementation

- Pop-up: “Correct! Kindness +10”
- Every quest ends in a lesson summary
- Characters exist only to model a moral
- The compassionate option is always obvious and superior
- Real-world advice is generated without review
- Children lose core access for not completing good habits

Writing rule

The story must still be entertaining if the player never consciously identifies the lesson.

SOCIAL SAFETY

No Open Chat

A deliberate creative advantage, not merely a missing feature.

There will be no unrestricted player-to-player chat, private messages or public comments. This removes major pathways for bullying, grooming, harassment, scams and social comparison. It also protects the central fantasy: The World is a place a child can enter without being judged by strangers.

- Players can still feel part of something through anonymous global event totals.
- Preset reactions or emotes may be considered later only in tightly bounded contexts.
- Leaderboards should default to private, friends-and-family or anonymised placement rather than public usernames.
- Trading, if introduced, should use protected systems with hard value limits and no direct messaging.
- The game should never pressure children to recruit friends in exchange for rewards.

Community without exposure

“Wayfinders have lit 742,391 lanterns” can create shared excitement without exposing a child to anyone else.

NON-NEGOTIABLES

Child Safety and Privacy Baseline

Safety requirements must shape architecture from the beginning.

Area	Master requirement
Identity	Use nicknames; never require public real names, schools, precise locations or profile photos.
Guardian accounts	Separate authentication and permissions. A child cannot access guardian email, approvals or payment controls.
Sensitive topics	Use authored and reviewed content. Do not use unrestricted AI conversation for health, abuse, relationships or crisis advice.
Purchases	Guardian-gated, transparent pricing, no loot boxes, no gambling-like mechanics and no countdown pressure targeted at children.
Data	Collect the minimum necessary, define retention rules, encrypt sensitive data and maintain auditable consent records.
Reporting	Provide parent support and content-reporting channels even without player chat.
Analytics	Avoid invasive behavioural profiling. Use product analytics for safety, reliability and broad improvement.
Deletion	Guardians can export or delete associated data through a clear process.

Before public release, obtain specialised legal and privacy review for every country in which children can register. The build should be designed for compliance, but this bible is not legal advice.

SECTION 03

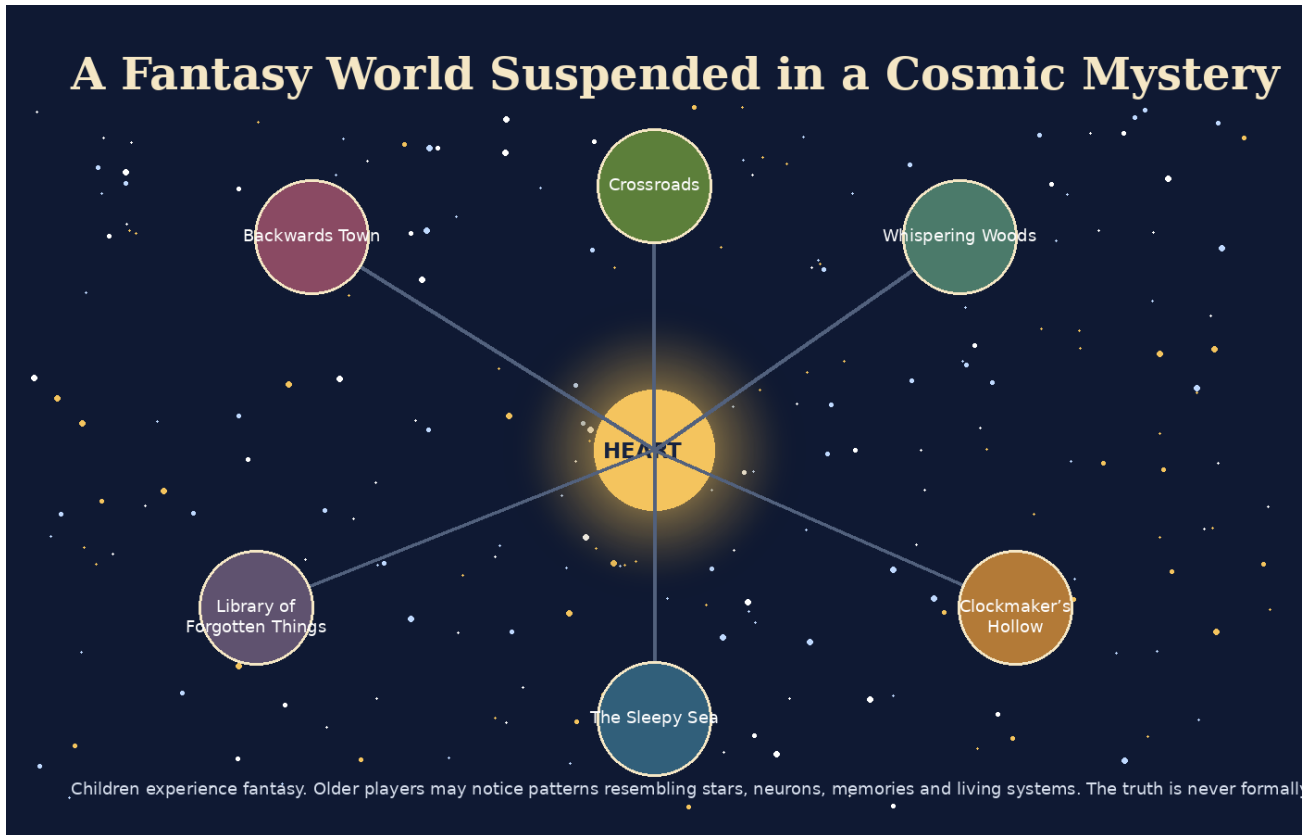
The Universe and Its Places

Fantasy on the surface; cosmic mystery underneath.

LORE FOUNDATION

The Hidden Cosmology

The World can be interpreted as a mind, a living system, a galaxy or something stranger - without confirming any one answer.



Conceptual cosmology. This is a lore relationship map, not the final player-facing world map.

Children encounter magical realms connected through The Between. Older players may notice recurring shapes and language resembling neurons, constellations, memories, dreams, black holes and living systems. The design team knows the underlying pattern, but the game never delivers a final “you were inside a brain” reveal.

Mystery rule

The hidden theme should enrich every place without becoming a puzzle that invalidates the fantasy world. Backwards Town must still be a wonderful town even if it also represents memory, time or reversed signals.

WORKING LORE

The Between, the Heartstar and the Crossroads

Three concepts that hold the universe together.

Concept	Player-facing meaning	Deeper design meaning
The Between	The luminous space and paths connecting realms.	A visual language that can resemble space, thought, dreams or biological networks.
The Heartstar	A distant warm light seen from many worlds. Nobody agrees what it is.	The recurring centre of the hidden cosmology; it may suggest consciousness, creation or a cosmic source.
The Crossroads	The safe hub where Wayfinders arrive and paths open.	The practical account hub, player home district, travel interface and update anchor.
Wayfinders	Explorers who notice paths others miss.	The player role: curiosity rather than destiny grants access.
Echoes	Objects, creatures or places carrying pieces of other realms.	A flexible explanation for collectibles, memories, seasonal remnants and cross-world mysteries.

These are working terms, not locked marketing names. Any renaming must preserve the conceptual relationships.

EXPERIENCE MODEL

World Structure

The illustrated page system creates depth through nested places.

The Experience Architecture

The World

Illustrated realms, maps, towns and mysteries

Places

Clickable scenes, buildings, NPCs and hidden hotspots

Activities

Stories, battles, games, gathering, puzzles and home quests

Progress

Companion growth, collections, home, abilities and reputation

Return

Dailies, seasonal changes, new chapters and secrets

The world feels vast because each layer feeds the next. It does not need to be one continuous 3D map.

A realm is not a single background. It is a network of illustrated scenes, interiors, characters, activities and state changes. A single town overview might expose twelve hotspots. Each hotspot can branch into an interior, dialogue scene, shop, quest, game or secret. This makes the world feel much larger than its code footprint.

- **Realm map:** A large illustrated destination or constellation map.
- **Location scene:** A town, forest, shoreline, station or neighbourhood with clickable hotspots.
- **Interior scene:** A bakery, library, workshop, home, cave or hidden room.
- **Interaction layer:** Dialogue, shop, inventory, puzzle, battle or game.
- **State variation:** Day/night, weather, completed quests, seasons, repairs and hidden discoveries.
- **Enterable picture:** Occasional mini-game or walkable micro-zone that makes a scene feel physically explorable.

WORLD PLANNING

Initial Realm Portfolio

A balanced world needs places with strong rules, moods and gameplay identities.

Realm	Signature rule	Gameplay role
The Crossroads	Warm hub between worlds	Arrival, home, map, festivals, recurring NPCs
Backwards Town	Everything follows a playful reverse logic	Comedy, first quests, Rewind Arcade, time mysteries
Whispering Woods	The forest remembers voices and unfinished songs	Exploration, listening, hidden paths, empathy stories
Library of Forgotten Things	Lost ideas, objects and memories wait to be found	Collections, lore, puzzles, unfinished stories
Clockmaker's Hollow	Time is repaired, borrowed and occasionally misplaced	Crafting, timers, schedules, mechanical creatures
The Sleepy Sea	An ocean suspended beneath a night sky	Fishing, dreams, calm games, floating islands
Lantern Valley	Lights appear for acts of courage and care	Seasonal events, shared goals, gentle mysteries
Umbrella Desert	Rain falls upward and shade is valuable	Resource puzzles, weather mechanics, comic NPCs
Moss Giant's Garden	A civilisation lives across a sleeping giant	Gardening, scale, creature care, environmental stories

Realm test

A child should be able to describe each major realm in one memorable sentence. "The town where everything happens backwards" is stronger than "the medieval village area."

FLAGSHIP PLACE

Backwards Town

The first signature realm and the creative benchmark for future locations.

Backwards Town is funny immediately, but it should not be a one-joke location. Its reverse logic influences architecture, schedules, quests, games, language and deeper mysteries. The town is welcoming and slightly bewildering. Residents treat its rules as completely ordinary.

Visible magic • Visitors exit before they enter • Dessert is served first • The post office delivers yesterday’s mail tomorrow • The bakery unbakes bread • Shop shelves refill when items are returned • The mayor begins speeches with “goodbye” • The arcade celebrates low scores in one game and reversed time in another	Deeper story possibilities • A resident is afraid of moving forward • A broken clock remembers tomorrow • A letter arrives before it is written • A child learns that mistakes can be repaired without being erased • An old road only appears when walked backwards • The town may sit near a fold in The Between
Tone Clever, warm and strange. Never use backwards logic to make controls frustrating or text unreadable. The joke belongs in the world, not in hostile UX.	

SECTION 04

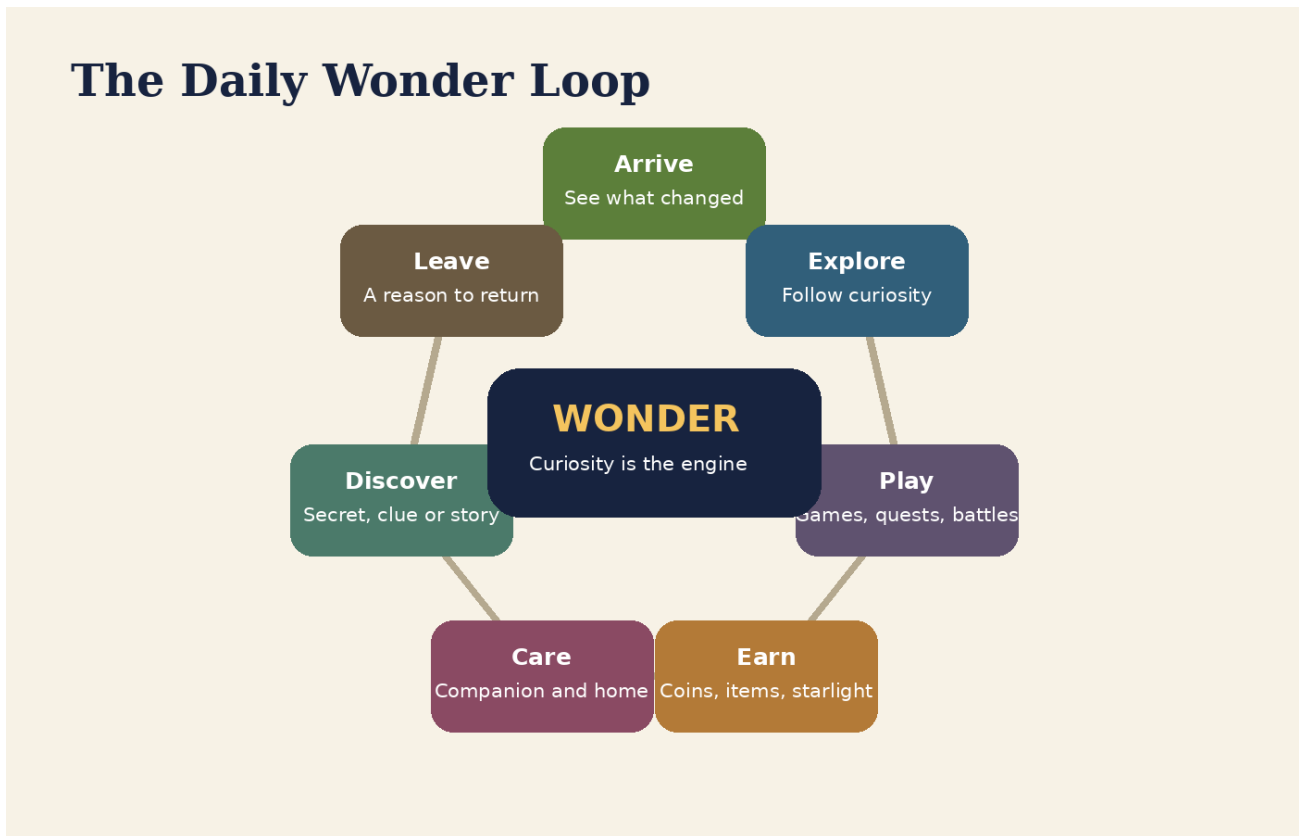
Core Gameplay and Progression

Give the player many reasons to care, without making everything a grind.

CORE LOOP

The Daily Wonder Loop

A comfortable routine with room for surprise.



A session may last five minutes or several hours. The player should be able to collect a gift, check on their companion and leave, or follow a chain of discoveries across several realms. There is no energy system forcing the player to stop and no punishment for taking a break.

- The homepage or Crossroads visibly reflects current events and weather.
- At least one returning NPC has fresh dialogue or a small state change.
- A short activity provides reliable progress.
- A mystery or rare occurrence provides uncertainty and wonder.
- The player leaves with a clear but non-urgent reason to return.

RETENTION MODEL

Long-Term Progression

Players should build a personal history, not merely a larger number.

Progress layer	Examples	Why it matters
Explorer	Outfits, tools, titles, learned abilities	Personal identity and expression.
Companion	Trust, traits, appearance changes, abilities	Emotional bond and long-term uniqueness.
Home	Rooms, garden, displays, trophies, music	A visible private record of the journey.
Collections	Books, stars, recipes, creatures, oddities	Goals for many play styles.
Relationships	NPC memory, unlocked dialogue, invitations	The world feels responsive.
World state	Repaired locations, opened doors, seasonal history	Progress changes places, not only menus.
Skills	Fishing, crafting, gardening, navigation, combat	Mastery and varied play.
Lore	Clues, maps, Echoes, theories	Long-term mystery and discussion without chat.

Progression rule

A player returning after six months should feel welcomed, not punished by a mountain of expired obligations.

NARRATIVE SYSTEM

Quest and Story Model

Stories are built from authored nodes and world state, not unrestricted AI improvisation.

Quests should range from two-minute interactions to multi-week mysteries. Each quest stores prerequisites, age-adapted dialogue, choices, state changes, rewards, revisits and optional branches. AI may assist writing during production, but final child-facing dialogue must be reviewed and stored as controlled content.

Quest type	Typical length	Example
Tiny kindness	2-5 minutes	Return a dropped parcel without being asked.
Character chapter	10-25 minutes	Help the Backwards Baker stop trying to erase every imperfect loaf.
Realm mystery	Several sessions	Discover why tomorrow's mail has stopped arriving.
Seasonal story	1-4 weeks	Relight Lantern Valley before the longest night.
Long lore arc	Months or years	Trace recurring Heartstar symbols across different realms.
Home Quest bridge	Real-world task plus short game scene	Help at home, then receive materials to repair a tiny in-world bridge.

- Avoid binary saint/monster choices.
- Let players repair mistakes.
- Use consequences as story variation, not permanent account damage.
- Never create an irreversible choice involving sensitive personal themes for a child.

COMBAT DIRECTION

Battle System

AdventureQuest-style clarity, modern presentation and multiple ways to resolve conflict.

Combat is theatrical and turn-based, launched from illustrated story pages. It should be easy to understand on touchscreens and satisfying in short sessions. Battles are not the moral centre of the world, but they provide strategy, spectacle and progression.

Player action	Purpose
Strike	Reliable basic action; visually adapted to equipped tool or class.
Ability	Character skill with cooldown or resource cost.
Companion action	Support, distraction, protection, healing or environmental interaction.
Item	Use food, potion, tool or quest object.
Defend	Reduce harm and set up a response.
Observe	Reveal a weakness, emotion, clue or alternative resolution.
Kindness / cleverness option	Context-specific action earned by paying attention; never a generic “win button.”

Conflict rule

Not every opponent is evil, not every battle ends in defeat, and no creature should be killed for comic reward. Enemies can retreat, calm down, change form, apologise, be repaired or become allies.

GAME PLATFORM

Arcade and Mini-Games

Original games inspired by classic genres, connected to the wider world.

The arcade is not a separate content dump. Every mini-game belongs to a place, character or story. Scores award capped coins, collections, cosmetic unlocks or quest materials. The platform should support keyboard, touch and gamepad where practical.

Working title	Core genre	World connection
Rewind Run	Endless runner where time briefly reverses	Backwards Town
Unbake!	Fast sorting and timing game that reconstructs ingredients	Yesterday's Bakery
Lantern Lift	Physics puzzle carrying lights through rising wind	Lantern Valley
Moonlake Fishing	Calm timing and collection game	The Sleepy Sea
Goblin Gold Rush	Mine-cart route and risk game	Forgotten Mines
Potion Panic	Recipe and pattern game	A travelling alchemist
Dragon Defender	Accessible lane or tower defence	A later battle realm
Whisper Catcher	Audio-visual memory game	Whispering Woods

- No direct clones of copyrighted levels, characters, music or art.
- Build a reusable score, pause, reward, accessibility and input framework once.
- A polished game with strong sound and animation is better than ten unfinished games.
- Daily score rewards must be capped to protect the economy.

HYBRID EXPLORATION

Walkable Areas

Use movement as a special mode, not the default structure.

Approximately seventy percent of the world should remain illustrated click-through scenes, twenty percent mini-games and battles, and ten percent small walkable areas. This ratio preserves the scale and storytelling advantage while making selected pictures feel enterable.

Good walkable zones

- A maze-like forest with hidden trails
- A mine where movement is part of a puzzle
- A festival square with stalls
- A small dungeon or ruin
- A shoreline used for fishing and collecting
- A dream sequence where physics changes

Avoid

- Rebuilding every town as a tile map
- Long empty roads between useful places
- Movement added only because games “should” have walking
- Complex real-time multiplayer presence
- Touch controls that obscure the whole phone screen
- Making important accessibility content depend on precise movement

Reveal moment

The first time a player clicks a scene and their explorer steps into it should feel like a genuine surprise.

PERSISTENT RELATIONSHIP

Companion System

The emotional heart of the account, designed to become personal over time.

Companions are not ordinary pets and should not resemble existing collectible-creature franchises. They are small beings touched by The Between. Their appearance and abilities slowly respond to the player's choices, favourite activities, realms visited and relationship history.

Layer	Design direction
Selection	Choose from a small set of species or origins with distinct silhouettes and personalities.
Bond	Built through regular care, shared quests and respectful choices - not constant feeding meters.
Traits	Curious, cautious, playful, observant, brave, patient and other non-ranked tendencies.
Appearance	Subtle growth: sprouts, markings, glow, fins, crystals, feathers or star patterns.
Abilities	Battle support, finding clues, accessing small spaces, calming creatures, gathering materials.
Communication	Expressive animation, sounds and authored short dialogue where appropriate.
Failure protection	Companions never permanently leave, become sick from absence or shame the child for not logging in.

Uniqueness principle

Two players choosing the same starter companion should be able to develop visibly different companions after months of play.

OWNERSHIP

Explorer, Home and Collections

Three surfaces where the player’s history becomes visible.

Explorer identity • Nickname, broad age path and avatar style • Outfits earned from places and stories • Tools and ability loadouts • Private titles and achievements • Accessibility choices preserved across devices	Player home • A room at the Crossroads • Display shelves for meaningful finds • Garden or tiny exterior space • Companion resting area • Music, wallpaper and seasonal decorations • Locked door hinting at a later mystery
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Collections should be presented as beautiful books, cabinets, maps and displays rather than spreadsheet-like completion lists. Examples include the Atlas of Impossible Places, Book of Unfinished Stories, Cabinet of Tiny Wonders, Constellation Journal, Recipe Ledger and Creature Sketchbook.

Collection rule A collection entry should tell the player where an item came from and why it matters. Rarity without story quickly becomes clutter.

SECTION 05

Family and Real-World Systems

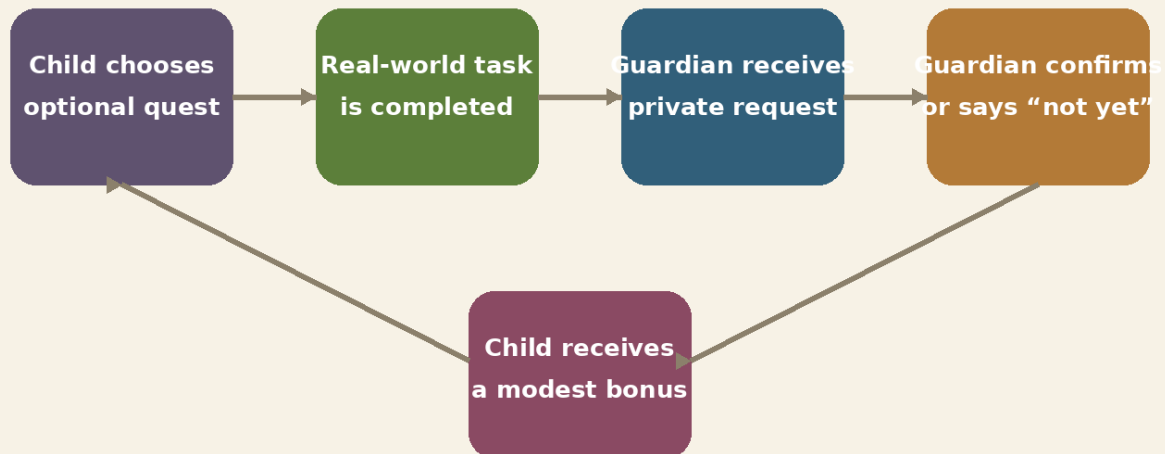
Connect home and game gently, privately and optionally.

FAMILY FEATURE

Home Quests

Optional real-world actions can create small in-world bonuses after guardian approval.

Home Quest Approval Flow



Rules: no punishment, no compulsory chores, no public status, no child access to guardian email, and no unlimited reward fa

Home Quests may include helping set the table, putting away toys, reading, preparing a school bag, feeding a pet, practising a routine or completing a custom family task. They must remain optional. A child who never uses Home Quests still receives the complete magical adventure.

- The child selects or accepts a task and marks it complete.
- The guardian receives a private email or dashboard approval request.
- The guardian can confirm, choose "not yet," or send a short preset/custom encouraging message.
- The reward is modest and capped: Starlight, coins, materials or a decorative progress item.
- Custom tasks require guardian creation and cannot expose private text publicly.
- Repeated tasks use cooldowns and weekly caps to prevent reward farming.

Never do this

Do not punish the child, lock story content, shame them, notify other players or create a public "good child" score.

PARENT SYSTEM

Guardian Experience

A separate practical portal that never breaks the child’s fantasy.

Guardian capability	Requirement
Link account	Secure invitation or code; child cannot see guardian credentials.
Approve Home Quests	Fast email action plus full dashboard history.
Create routines	Optional recurring tasks with reward limits and age-appropriate labels.
Purchase controls	Disable purchases, require confirmation, set spending limits and review history.
Play reminders	Optional gentle reminders, never forced logout during a save-sensitive activity.
Age path and accessibility	Adjust reading path, motion, sound and support settings.
Wish lists	View child-selected real-world ideas only when explicitly enabled.
Privacy controls	Export, unlink or request deletion of family data.
Encouragement	Send limited messages that appear as private notes from home, clearly identified as guardian messages.

Separation rule

The guardian portal should look calm and trustworthy, but it should not reuse the child’s fantasy language so heavily that approvals become confusing.

OPTIONAL FAMILY UTILITY

Seasonal Wish Lists

A magical ritual can privately help families without turning the world into an advertisement.

During an enabled winter or birthday event, a child can visit a magical post office and create a list of things they like. In-world items remain separate from real-world wishes. The guardian receives the real-world list privately. The child is never told that a purchase is guaranteed.

- Guardians choose whether Christmas, another celebration, birthdays or no wish-list events are enabled.
- The system supports typed wishes, broad categories and links added by the guardian - not unrestricted external browsing by children.
- No brand pays to influence the child's list.
- The child can revise the list; the guardian sees timestamps and changes.
- After the season, the child-facing list becomes a memory page or is archived according to guardian preference.
- Marketing and store links must never be disguised as NPC recommendations.

Tone example

"The Winter Traveller reads every letter, but even magic cannot promise every wish."

LIVE WORLD

Seasonal Events

The world should visibly change, not merely display a banner.

Event	Season	World effect
First Rains	Autumn	Upward rain begins in the Umbrella Desert; new plants appear elsewhere.
Longest Night	Winter	Players light lanterns across realms; the Heartstar is unusually faint.
Bloomwake	Spring	Paths grow overnight; companion sprouts and gardens change.
Sky Carnival	Summer	A travelling floating fair arrives with games and strange prizes.
Backwards Day	Special	Backwards Town temporarily behaves normally and residents find it alarming.
Constellation Opening	Lore event	A new realm appears when anonymous global discoveries reach a threshold.

- Homepage art, lighting, music and small animations change.
- Existing NPCs receive event dialogue and outfits.
- Temporary content should leave permanent memories, book entries or decorations.
- Avoid fear-of-missing-out pressure and extremely short purchase windows.
- Repeat events may evolve rather than reset identically.

BUSINESS MODEL

Economy and Monetisation

Support the world without corrupting it.

The game is predominantly free. Revenue can come from cosmetics, expanded personalisation, optional membership conveniences, merchandise and guardian-approved purchases. Spending should express affection for the world, not remove artificial pain.

Allowed direction	Examples
Cosmetics	Outfits, home themes, companion accessories, animation packs and seasonal decoration sets.
Account expansion	Additional home rooms, extra outfit presets or additional companion slots with clear limits.
Optional membership	Monthly cosmetic allowance, expanded storage, bonus decorating tools and behind-the-scenes content.
Merchandise	Plush companions, books, art prints, cards and physical collectibles.
Supporter purchases	One-off founder or patron cosmetics that do not convey gameplay power.
Guardian gifting	Directly purchase a known item; no randomised loot.

Prohibited	Reason
Loot boxes or paid random rewards	Gambling-like pressure and poor transparency.
Pay-to-win stats or exclusive story endings	Undermines the shared world and free-player promise.
Artificial energy sold for cash	Turns playtime into monetised frustration.
Child-targeted countdown pressure	Exploits urgency and fear of missing out.
Ads disguised as characters or quests	Breaks trust and manipulates children.
Public spending status	Creates comparison and social pressure.

SECTION 06

Art, Interface and Content Production

Consistency is what separates a real world from a folder of AI images.

ART BIBLE

Visual Direction

A richly illustrated storybook world with cinematic depth and gentle movement.



Current homepage reference: atmosphere and quality target, not a final locked design.

- Hand-painted storybook aesthetic combining gouache, watercolour texture and polished digital illustration.
- Warm, natural light and layered depth rather than flat vector art.
- Whimsical architecture with believable construction and coherent regional materials.
- Original companion silhouettes and characters; avoid visual proximity to existing franchises.
- Detailed scenes with calm negative space reserved for real HTML interface elements.
- Animation is subtle: wind, clouds, lights, water, idle breathing and occasional environmental events.
- No baked-in interface text, generated gibberish signage or unreadable AI lettering.

Art test

A screenshot without buttons should still look like a page from a beautiful illustrated book. A screenshot with buttons should still look like a functioning game.

IMAGE GENERATION RULES

Visual Consistency Contract

Cursor must establish shared references before generating production assets.

1. Create a visual bible containing palette, rendering style, lighting examples, architecture rules, character proportions, line treatment, material references and prohibited looks.
2. Create model sheets for recurring characters and companions: front, side, three-quarter, expressions, scale and colour references.
3. Create one approved hero image for each realm before generating interiors, objects or variations.
4. Generate backgrounds without important UI text, characters or animation objects when those elements need independent control.
5. Generate moving objects as separate transparent assets: windmill blades, balloons, clouds, smoke, lantern glow, water overlays and character idle parts.
6. Use fixed asset naming, versioning and prompt metadata so later scenes can reproduce the style.
7. Reject and regenerate assets with anatomy errors, inconsistent buildings, nonsensical object placement, visible signatures or accidental franchise resemblance.
8. Optimise approved originals into AVIF/WebP derivatives; preserve the high-resolution source outside the public web bundle.

Never accept “close enough” characters

If a recurring NPC changes face, clothing construction or scale between screens, the world immediately looks fake. Character consistency has higher priority than producing content quickly.

CURSOR PRODUCTION TEMPLATE

Master Background Prompt Template

A reusable prompt structure for every illustrated location.

Template: realm or location background

Generate a high-resolution 16:9 illustrated background for an original children's fantasy browser world named The World. Scene: [LOCATION AND VIEWPOINT]. Realm identity: [SIGNATURE RULE, MATERIALS, COLOURS AND WEATHER]. Include [KEY LANDMARKS AND CLICKABLE HOTSPOT AREAS]. Mood: [EMOTIONAL GOAL]. Time and lighting: [SPECIFIC LIGHT]. Art direction: richly detailed hand-painted storybook environment, gouache and watercolour texture combined with polished digital painting, coherent architecture, layered cinematic depth, warm and magical without excessive saturation. Reserve calm visual space at [UI REGION] for real HTML interface. Do not include text, logos, buttons, visible UI, copyrighted characters, watermarks, signatures or generated writing. Do not include moving objects that need separate animation layers: [LIST]. No photorealism, no generic flat vector style, no random collage composition.

Production notes: Generate at least one clean desktop master. Create a deliberate portrait/mobile crop or separate composition when the desktop scene cannot crop safely.

Template: transparent character asset

Generate a full-body transparent-background illustration of [CHARACTER NAME AND ROLE] for The World. Match the approved visual bible and reference sheet exactly. Age, proportions and silhouette: [DETAILS]. Clothing and materials: [DETAILS]. Pose and expression: [DETAILS]. Lighting direction: [DETAILS]. Painterly storybook rendering with clean transparent edges and consistent scale. No scenery, text, logos, weapons unless explicitly required, franchise resemblance, duplicate limbs, malformed hands or cropped body parts.

INTERACTION COMPOSITION

Scene and Hotspot Design

Every picture should invite clicking without looking like a hidden-object advertisement.

Element	Rule
Primary landmarks	Three to six obvious destinations with distinctive silhouettes.
Secondary hotspots	Small characters, signs, windows, paths or objects discovered through cursor/touch feedback.
Secret hotspots	Rare or state-dependent; never required without a discoverable clue.
UI safe zone	Calm region reserved for title, menu or dialogue.
Depth layers	Foreground framing, playable middle ground and distant worldbuilding.
Animation anchors	Clear positions for separate moving assets; coordinates stored relative to scene.
Responsive crop	Important landmarks remain reachable on tablet and phone; use alternate composition if needed.
Accessibility map	Every hotspot exists in keyboard order and an optional labelled list or discovery mode.

Hotspot feedback

Hover or focus may add a soft glow, movement, label or sound. Do not cover the artwork in permanent icons unless an accessibility setting requests stronger guidance.

UI DIRECTION

Interface System

Real HTML controls should feel physically integrated into the illustrated world.

Component	Visual language
Primary action	Deep moss green, restrained gold detail, soft bevel, clear pressed state.
Secondary action	Warm parchment with dark ink and illustrated icon.
Information action	Muted purple or navy, book/map motifs.
Dialogue panel	Illustrated parchment or material appropriate to the realm, with readable text and portrait.
Inventory	Cabinet, satchel or field journal metaphor; responsive grid beneath the visual framing.
Modal	Travel journal, book spread or framed panel; focus trapped and keyboard accessible.
Selection	Gold outline plus icon/check shape, not colour alone.
Loading	Small world-specific animation and useful progress language; never a blank spinner on white.
Error	Calm, specific and recoverable. A lost-path metaphor may decorate but must not obscure the fix.

- Buttons must remain large enough for touch.
- Never bake essential labels into images.
- Text remains readable over every seasonal background.
- UI motion honours reduced-motion preferences.
- Do not make children decipher decorative fonts for routine controls.

ATMOSPHERE

Animation and Audio

Movement should make the page breathe, not demand attention.

Animation priorities • Slow environmental loops • Purposeful character idles • Clear click and reward feedback • Rare surprising events • Layered parallax with restrained movement • Reduced-motion alternatives	Audio priorities • Distinct realm ambience • Memorable but gentle music themes • Crisp tactile interface sounds • Character motifs and companion noises • No autoplay before user interaction • Independent music and sound controls
--	---

Use CSS transforms, lightweight video loops, sprite sheets or canvas effects depending on the asset. Keep moving objects separate when possible. Never animate an entire large background merely to make one waterfall move.

Silence is valid The complete experience must remain understandable and emotionally coherent with audio disabled.

MULTI-DEVICE

Responsive Experience

The World must feel designed for desktop, iPad and phone - not shrunk to fit.

Device	Design approach
Desktop	Full cinematic scene, pointer hover, subtle parallax, side panels and broad landscape composition.
Tablet landscape	Near-desktop composition with larger targets and reduced decorative UI.
Tablet portrait	Recompose panels vertically; preserve artwork focus and provide touch-friendly hotspot access.
Phone portrait	Use intentional portrait crops or separate artwork. Stack actions, reduce decoration and avoid tiny hotspots.
Phone landscape	Support game modes where useful, but never require rotation for core navigation.
Installed PWA	Home-screen icon, safe-area support, offline shell and app-like navigation without hiding browser accessibility.

Mobile image rule

If the desktop crop removes the explorer, companion or primary destination, create a separate mobile composition. Do not accept a technically responsive but emotionally empty crop.

CMS DIRECTION

Content Production Model

The world must grow through reusable structured content, not hard-coded pages.

Content type	Core fields
Realm	Name, summary, hero art, palette, music, entry rules, seasonal variants.
Scene	Background layers, hotspots, UI region, ambience, state conditions, mobile composition.
Hotspot	Coordinates, shape, label, action, state visibility, keyboard order, sound and animation.
NPC	Reference sheet, portraits, role, traits, relationships, dialogue sets and state memory.
Quest	Prerequisites, nodes, choices, age variants, rewards, world changes and replay rules.
Item	Art, description, category, source, rarity, trade rules, price and collection links.
Game	Launch config, controls, reward caps, score rules, accessibility and version.
Event	Dates, eligibility, scene variations, tasks, rewards, archive and recurrence.
Home Quest	Guardian-defined or system task, approval rule, cap, age labels and reward mapping.

The content system should support previewing a complete scene with a chosen player state before publication. Production staff should not need to edit source code to change dialogue, hotspot visibility or seasonal artwork.

SECTION 07

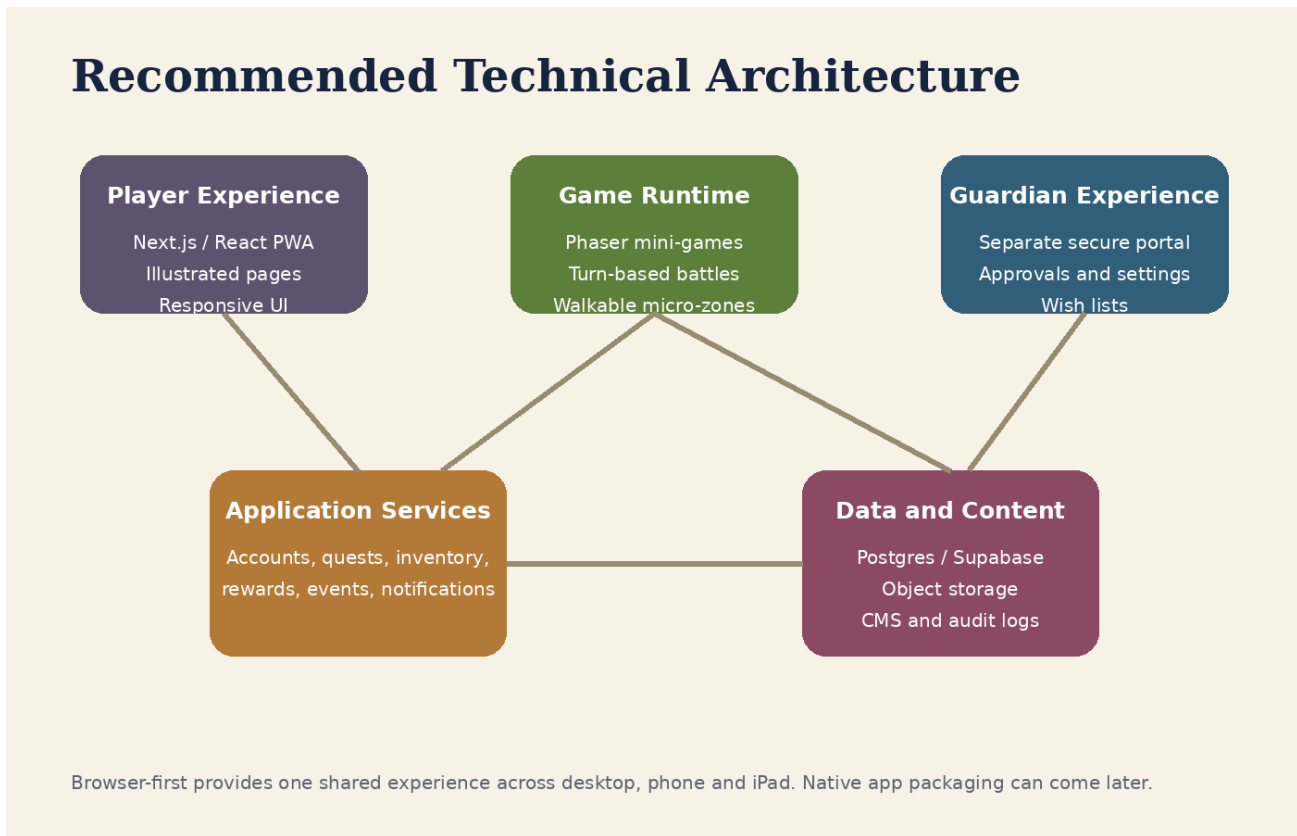
Technology, Data and Operations

Build the content engine and safety boundaries before scaling the world.

TECHNICAL FOUNDATION

Recommended Architecture

Browser-first, component-driven and expandable.



- **Application:** Next.js, React and TypeScript for world pages, account surfaces and guardian portal.
- **Game runtime:** Phaser for mini-games, battles and selected walkable micro-zones.
- **Backend:** Postgres and Supabase-style services for authentication, data, realtime events where necessary and row-level security.
- **Storage:** Object storage for layered art, optimised derivatives, audio, video loops and downloadable source packages.
- **Content:** A structured CMS with draft, preview, review and publish states.
- **Delivery:** Progressive Web App first; Capacitor/native packaging only after browser experience is strong.
- **Notifications:** Transactional email to guardians; no direct child-to-stranger communication channels.
- **Observability:** Error tracking, performance monitoring, audit logs and safety-focused analytics.

Why not Unreal

The primary experience is illustrated scenes, content systems, responsive interfaces and lightweight games. A web stack is faster to produce, easier to update and naturally supports browser, phone and iPad.

DATA ARCHITECTURE

High-Level Data Model

Separate player fantasy data from guardian identity and approval data.

Entity	Purpose
accounts	Authentication identity and account status.
player_profiles	Nickname, age path, explorer style, preferences and onboarding state.
guardian_profiles	Guardian identity, consent, notification and billing settings.
guardian_links	Permissioned relationship between guardian and child account.
companions	Species, appearance traits, bond, abilities and history.
player_inventory	Item ownership, quantity, source and lock state.
player_currency	Balances and append-only transaction references.
quests / quest_progress	Authored quest definitions and player state.
scenes / hotspots	Published content and interaction definitions.
npc_relationships	Per-player flags, dialogue state and memory.
home_quests	Task definition, recurrence and reward policy.
home_quest_submissions	Child claim, guardian decision, message and audit timestamps.
events / participation	Seasonal configuration and player progress.
purchase_ledger	Guardian-approved transactions and refunds.
audit_logs	Sensitive guardian, reward, moderation and publication actions.

Currency integrity

Every balance change should reference an append-only transaction record. Never rely solely on a mutable “coins” number that can change without an audit trail.

ENGINEERING RULES

Security and Permission Boundaries

Convenient prototypes must not become unsafe production foundations.

- Use server-side authorisation for rewards, purchases, guardian actions and content access.
- Apply row-level data policies so accounts can read only permitted records.
- Never trust game scores, task completion or currency changes sent directly from a browser.
- Use signed, expiring guardian approval links with clear context and a login fallback.
- Rate-limit account creation, email actions, reward claims and sensitive endpoints.
- Store secrets only in environment configuration, never client bundles or generated prompts.
- Maintain separate draft and published content states.
- Log sensitive changes while avoiding storage of unnecessary child behaviour detail.
- Create automated tests for cross-account access and guardian-link permissions.
- Design account recovery so a child cannot take over a guardian identity or vice versa.

Prototype warning

Local storage is acceptable for an isolated visual prototype. It is not acceptable for real currency, guardian approvals, purchases or child account security.

SHIPPING DISCIPLINE

Quality Assurance

Every phase must end in a coherent journey that can be tested by a real person.

Test layer	Required checks
Visual	Desktop, tablet and phone screenshots; consistency with references; no placeholder art or broken crops.
Interaction	Keyboard, touch and pointer; every hotspot and button; back navigation; state persistence.
Accessibility	Focus order, labels, contrast, reduced motion, text scaling, audio-independent meaning.
Content	Age variants, spelling, lore consistency, sensitive-language review and missing states.
Economy	Reward limits, duplicate claims, transaction logs and exploit attempts.
Safety	Permission boundaries, guardian separation, data minimisation and purchase gates.
Performance	Largest contentful paint, image weight, animation cost, slow networks and lower-end phones.
Resilience	Reload during actions, expired links, offline interruption, failed email and partial content load.
Regression	Automated flows for onboarding, travel, quest completion, reward claim and guardian approval.

Phase exit gate

A phase is not complete because every ticket is closed. It is complete when its intended player journey works, looks coherent and survives the defined tests.

OPERATIONS

Live Operations and Analytics

Use data to protect and improve the world, not manipulate children.

Useful signals • Crashes and failed interactions • Slow scene loads and device classes • Quest abandonment caused by confusion • Accessibility-setting usage • Economy inflation and exploit patterns • Guardian approval delivery failures • Content reports and support themes • Broad return patterns after new chapters	Avoid • Psychological targeting of individual children • Aggressive retention scoring • Selling behavioural profiles • Manipulative push notifications • Using private Home Quest details for marketing • Optimising purchases through distress or urgency • Publicly ranking children by playtime or spending
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Live operations require a content calendar, event rollback plan, support ownership, incident response process, reward correction tools and the ability to disable a broken game or hotspot without redeploying the entire site.

SECTION 08

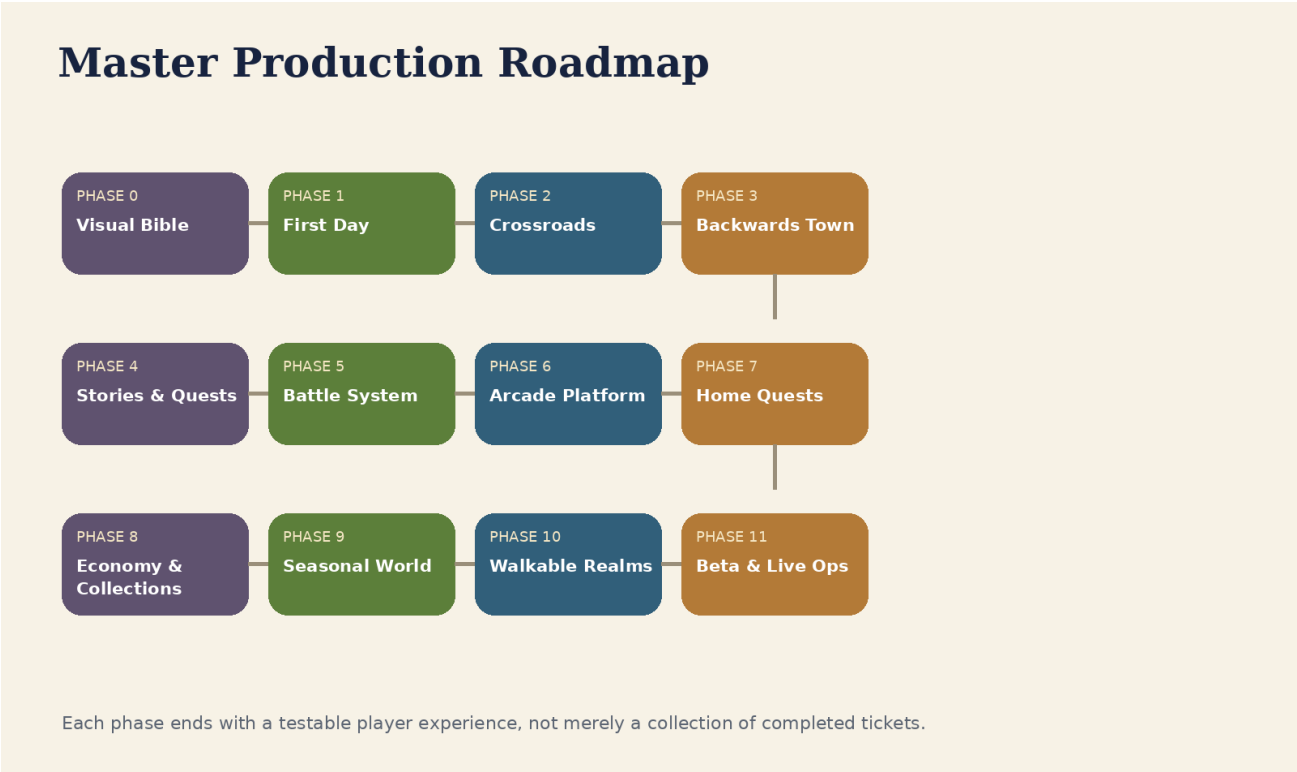
Master Production Roadmap

Build a small world that feels real, then expand it safely.

SEQUENCE

Roadmap at a Glance

Twelve phases move from visual proof to a sustainable live world.



The sequence is intentional. The team first proves the visual identity and opening experience, then creates the reusable world and story systems, then adds combat and mini-games, then introduces guardian-connected features, economy depth, seasonal operations and walkable zones. Safety and technical foundations are refined continuously, with a dedicated beta phase before public launch.

Scope rule

Do not begin mass-generating realms before one complete realm proves the scene, hotspot, NPC, quest, reward, responsive and content-publication systems.

PRODUCTION ROADMAP

Phase 0: Vision and Visual Bible

Create the shared source material that prevents every later screen from drifting.

Phase goal
Lock the emotional target, working lore, design language and recurring visual references.

Player outcome A viewer can recognise The World from a screenshot without seeing the logo.	Build outcome Approved visual bible, UI kit, character sheets, asset rules and prototype repository foundation.
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- Dependencies:** This master bible and the approved homepage reference.
- Create final palette and typography tests.
 - Create explorer proportion and clothing guide.
 - Design at least three companion silhouette families.
 - Create Crossroads and Backwards Town realm mood boards.
 - Create component examples: button, panel, dialogue, modal, inventory tile and loading state.
 - Create desktop, tablet and phone art-cropping rules.
 - Establish asset metadata: prompt, seed/reference, version, source, derivative formats and usage rights.

PHASE 0 DETAIL

Phase 0 Screen and Asset Inventory

This phase produces references, not the complete game.

Deliverable	Minimum output
Brand mark	Primary wordmark, compact mark, monochrome and small-size variants.
Homepage style frame	Desktop and phone compositions with approved atmosphere.
Explorer model sheet	Four starter directions plus proportion and pose standards.
Companion exploration	At least twelve silhouettes, reduced to three coherent families.
NPC style frame	One older, one child, one non-human and one comic character.
Realm frames	Crossroads, Backwards Town and one cosmic Between scene.
UI kit	All basic controls in default, hover, focus, pressed, disabled and high-contrast states.
Motion guide	Wind, cloud, glow, idle, transition and reduced-motion examples.
Asset pipeline	Folder naming, optimisation, references and review checklist.

Exit gate

No production scene generation begins until recurring characters and the visual rendering style can be reproduced consistently across at least three separate images.

PRODUCTION ROADMAP

Phase 1: Your First Day

Prove that a new player can fall in love with the world before any large content library exists.

Phase goal
Build the complete opening journey from homepage through account setup, explorer and companion creation, arrival at the Crossroads and the first invitation toward Backwards Town.

Player outcome • The player feels welcomed, creates an identity, bonds with a companion and leaves wanting to return.	Build outcome • A production-quality responsive shell, account model, onboarding state, first cinematic scenes and reusable dialogue/navigation components.
--	--

Dependencies: Phase 0 visual bible and functioning secure account foundation.

- Animated homepage with windmill, balloon, clouds, waterfall and gentle character idle.
- Create account, log in, options and “What is The World?” states.
- Broad age-path selection and nickname guidance.
- Explorer appearance selection.
- Companion encounter and selection - framed as meeting rather than purchasing.
- Arrival through The Between.
- Crossroads introduction and first room assignment.
- First NPC conversation and the “missing tomorrow’s map” hook.
- Save and resume onboarding across devices.

PHASE 1 FLOW

Phase 1 Player Flow

Every arrow becomes a designed state in the detailed phase PDF.

1. Open the animated hilltop homepage and choose Start Adventure.
2. Create or log into an account with guardian-consent handling appropriate to the release jurisdiction.
3. Choose an explorer nickname, broad age path and starter appearance.
4. Follow lights into a small companion sanctuary and meet three possible companions through short authored scenes.
5. Choose a companion and complete a tiny bonding interaction.
6. Travel through The Between in a short layered transition.
7. Arrive at the Crossroads, where the world map is mostly dark.
8. Meet the first recurring guide, who gives the player a room and notices that tomorrow's map is missing.
9. Open the room, place the first keepsake and see a locked unexplained door.
10. Receive the first route marker toward Backwards Town and a calm invitation to continue now or return later.

Phase 1 reward

The player receives a small Wayfinder satchel, a first coin pouch, the companion's trust token and a map page with one destination glowing.

PHASE 1 ART

Phase 1 Image Production

The detailed phase PDF will define each screen individually; this is the master asset scope.

Asset family	Required direction
Homepage	Layered hill, valley, town, explorer, companion silhouette, windmill, balloon, clouds, waterfall and UI signs.
Onboarding trailhead	Woodland registration wagon, signpost, avatar preview area and age-card emblems.
Companion sanctuary	Warm circular room or grove with three distinct resting places; no pet-shop feeling.
The Between	Cosmic path that can resemble stars, dreams and neural light without becoming science fiction.
Crossroads arrival	Welcoming station/plaza with visible paths, locked routes and central Heartstar motif.
Player room	Small beautiful blank room with display shelf, companion corner and sealed door.
Guide NPC	Full model sheet, expressions, portraits and story poses.
UI	Account, dialogue, selection, accessibility, loading, error and save states.
Responsive variants	Intentional phone compositions for every full-scene screen.

Exit gate

A brand-new user can complete the entire first-day journey on desktop and phone, close the browser, return on another device and continue from the correct state.

PRODUCTION ROADMAP

Phase 2: The Crossroads and Player Home

Turn the opening location into a place the player actually inhabits.

Phase goal
Build the persistent hub, home, map, daily return surfaces and first recurring systems.

Player outcome The player has a reliable home base and several meaningful things to check without leaving the hub.	Build outcome Reusable scene state, home decoration, daily content, collections and travel interfaces.
---	---

- Dependencies:** Phase 1 account, companion and Crossroads arrival.
- Full Crossroads overview with hotspots: home district, map chamber, market cart, archive, portal garden and event square.
 - Player home interior, inventory, wardrobe and companion area.
 - Daily gift designed as a small world interaction rather than a calendar pop-up.
 - First collection books and achievement cabinet.
 - NPC revisit dialogue and relationship flags.
 - Map unlocking and route prerequisites.
 - News/event presentation integrated into the environment.
 - Private notification centre using letters or journal entries.

PHASE 2 DETAIL

Phase 2 Screen Inventory

The hub should support short daily visits before any major realm expansion.

Screen group	Examples
Crossroads	Main plaza, map chamber, archive entrance, market lane, portal garden, event square.
Home	Room overview, decorate mode, wardrobe, companion corner, shelf inspection, locked door.
Progress	Quest journal, Atlas, collections cabinet, achievements, currency and item details.
Daily	Gift scene, returning NPC, changed weather, small discovery and optional activity.
Travel	Realm map, destination card, locked-route explanation, arrival transition.
System	Settings, guardian-link prompt, accessibility, support and account management.

Exit gate
A player can spend fifteen satisfying minutes entirely within the Crossroads and leave with visible progress or a new curiosity.

PRODUCTION ROADMAP

Phase 3: Backwards Town

Launch one complete signature realm that proves the content engine.

Phase goal
Build a dense illustrated realm with memorable humour, character stories, shops, secrets and the first arcade.

Player outcome The player can explore for several sessions and describe the town as a place, not a feature demo.	Build outcome Reusable realm, scene, hotspot, shop, quest, NPC memory and game-launch systems.
---	---

- Dependencies:** Crossroads travel, inventory, currency and journal.
- Town arrival road and main overview.
 - Yesterday’s Bakery, Rewind Arcade, Tomorrow Post Office, Mayor’s Office, repair shop, inn and hidden lane.
 - At least eight recurring NPCs with visual sheets and relationship states.
 - One main town story, four character quests, several tiny interactions and two secrets.
 - First complete shop economy and item catalogue.
 - Two polished arcade games.
 - Day/night or normal/backwards event variation.
 - At least one optional alternative-resolution encounter.

PHASE 3 NARRATIVE

Phase 3 Core Story

The missing tomorrow's map leads somewhere funny, then somewhere meaningful.

The player arrives because the Crossroads guide believes tomorrow's map was accidentally delivered to Backwards Town. The post office insists it cannot be collected until yesterday. Investigation leads through the bakery, mayor, clock repairer and arcade. The apparent administrative joke gradually reveals that a nervous young clock-creature has been reversing deliveries because it is frightened of a future event.

- The player can solve practical problems while learning the town's logic.
- The frightened creature is not defeated as a villain; it can be understood and helped.
- The map is recovered, but one route on it points to a place that should not exist.
- Choices change later dialogue and a small town decoration, not access to the central story.
- Age variants adjust length and subtlety while preserving the same emotional truth.

Exit gate

Backwards Town contains enough polished content for an external tester to play across multiple sessions without seeing placeholder screens or unfinished systems.

PRODUCTION ROADMAP

Phase 4: Stories, Quests and World Memory

Create the system that lets the world respond over months and years.

Phase goal
Expand authored narrative tools, branching state and NPC memory beyond one realm.

Player outcome • Characters recognise the player and old choices create later surprises.	Build outcome • Quest editor, dialogue preview, localisation-ready content, state debugging and narrative analytics.
---	---

Dependencies: One complete realm demonstrating the requirements.

- Node-based authored dialogue with age-path variants.
- Quest prerequisites, branching, re-entry and recovery states.
- NPC relationship and memory flags.
- World-state changes and scene variants.
- Mail, invitations and delayed consequences.
- Content-review workflow with sensitive-theme flags.
- Testing tools to preview any player state.
- First cross-realm story connecting Backwards Town and Whispering Woods.

Exit gate
Writers can create and test a new multi-stage quest without changing application code, and engineers can inspect exactly why any dialogue branch appeared.

PRODUCTION ROADMAP

Phase 5: Battle System

Add satisfying strategic conflict without changing the world’s emotional identity.

Phase goal
Create the reusable turn-based battle framework and first encounters.

Player outcome • Players gain a new form of mastery and spectacle, with options beyond simply attacking.	Build outcome • Battle renderer, ability system, enemy logic, reward validation, accessibility and content tools.
---	--

Dependencies: Explorer stats, companion abilities, items and quest state.

- Responsive battle stage embedded within illustrated story context.
- Basic attack, ability, companion action, item, defend and observe actions.
- Enemy intent and readable status effects.
- Contextual alternate resolutions.
- Equipment and ability loadouts kept simple for first release.
- Server-authoritative outcome and rewards.
- Speed, animation and reduced-motion settings.
- Tutorial encounter and three distinct enemy archetypes.

Exit gate
The same battle is understandable and enjoyable with mouse, keyboard and touch, and remains readable with motion reduced and sound disabled.

PRODUCTION ROADMAP

Phase 6: Arcade Platform

Make it possible to add polished games without rebuilding account integration each time.

Phase goal
Build the shared mini-game shell and release the first small library.

Player outcome • Players can jump into varied games and bring meaningful rewards back to the world.	Build outcome • Phaser game SDK, score validation, input profiles, pause, accessibility, reward caps and leaderboards.
--	---

Dependencies: Currency ledger, inventory, event configuration and world launch points.

- Shared launch, loading, pause, result and reward screens.
- Keyboard, touch and gamepad input mapping.
- Game-specific tutorial and practice modes.
- Server validation or anti-cheat strategy appropriate to each game.
- Daily and weekly reward caps.
- Private best scores and optional anonymised event placement.
- Performance budget for lower-end phones.
- Initial games: Rewind Run, Unbake!, Moonlake Fishing and Whisper Catcher.

Exit gate
A new mini-game can be added using documented interfaces without custom rebuilding of login, currency, settings, rewards or responsive shell.

PRODUCTION ROADMAP

Phase 7: Home Quests and Guardian Portal

Introduce the optional family bridge only after the magical world stands on its own.

Phase goal
Build secure guardian linking, optional real-world tasks, approvals and family controls.

Player outcome A child can receive a small magical bonus for helpful real-life actions without feeling monitored or punished.	Build outcome Separate guardian portal, permissions, notification delivery, task rules, audit logs and privacy controls.
--	---

Dependencies: Stable accounts, reward ledger, child-safety review and legal input.

- Guardian invitation and linking flow.
- System and custom Home Quest creation.
- Child claim and guardian confirm/not-yet flow.
- Signed email action links and dashboard history.
- Reward caps, recurrence and anti-farming rules.
- Preset and limited custom encouragement messages.
- Purchase, age-path and accessibility controls.
- Export, unlink and deletion request processes.

Exit gate
Security testing demonstrates that a child cannot access guardian data, one guardian cannot access another family, and rewards cannot be claimed without authorised approval.

PRODUCTION ROADMAP

Phase 8: Economy, Shops, Crafting and Collections

Give items meaning and create sustainable goals without inflation or clutter.

Phase goal
Expand the item economy, shops, collections and crafting using auditable systems.

Player outcome Different play styles can pursue useful, decorative and story-rich goals.	Build outcome Item CMS, pricing tools, transaction analytics, crafting recipes, storage and collection displays.
---	---

- Dependencies:** Stable reward ledger, first realm shop data and player home displays.
- Clear currency roles: coins for ordinary trade, Starlight for special progress, event tokens only when necessary.
 - Shop stock rules and world-consistent pricing.
 - Crafting tied to places and characters rather than generic recipe spam.
 - Item provenance and collection stories.
 - Duplicate-item uses and safe sinks to control inflation.
 - Storage that is generous enough for collectors.
 - Protected gifting or trading only after safety review.
 - Cosmetic monetisation integrated without gameplay power.

Exit gate
Economy simulations and test accounts show stable earning and spending across new, regular and highly active play patterns.

PRODUCTION ROADMAP

Phase 9: Seasonal World and Wish Lists

Prove that the universe can change safely and memorably over time.

Phase goal
Launch event infrastructure, scene variants, shared goals and optional guardian-enabled wish-list rituals.

Player outcome • The player sees the world transform and carries permanent memories from temporary events.	Build outcome • Event CMS, scheduling, rollback, variation assets, archival entries and wish-list privacy model.
---	---

Dependencies: Content publication workflow, guardian portal and live-operations ownership.

- First major seasonal event across homepage, Crossroads and Backwards Town.
- Global anonymous progress meter with no direct communication.
- Event quests, games, items and permanent keepsakes.
- Scene variation and asset preloading.
- Repeat-event versioning and archive pages.
- Guardian choice of Christmas, alternative celebration, birthdays or disabled wish lists.
- Private real-world wish data separated from in-world favourites.
- Emergency event disable and reward correction tools.

Exit gate
The event can start and end automatically, be paused safely, preserve earned history and avoid leaving broken hotspots or inaccessible rewards.

PRODUCTION ROADMAP

Phase 10: Walkable Realms and Expanded Universe

Let selected illustrations become physical spaces while preserving the page-first identity.

Phase goal
Add reusable walkable micro-zones and open several new realms.

Player outcome • Players experience genuine movement and discovery as a special expansion of the world.	Build outcome • Top-down or side-view movement framework, zone editor, save points, accessibility and scene integration.
--	---

Dependencies: Stable world content, Phaser runtime and proven realm-production process.

- First zone: a hidden path inside Whispering Woods.
- Movement, collision, interaction and contextual controls.
- Touch layout that does not cover important play space.
- Accessible route guidance and reduced precision requirements.
- Scene-to-zone and zone-to-scene transitions.
- Collectibles and quest state synced with normal world pages.
- Additional realm launches using the established content engine.
- No attempt to convert every existing scene into a walkable level.

Exit gate
The first walkable zone feels like entering the picture, runs well on target phones and can be authored without modifying engine code.

PRODUCTION ROADMAP

Phase 11: Public Beta and Live Operations

Harden the complete experience before inviting a large child audience.

Phase goal

Test safety, performance, content clarity, economy and operations with controlled cohorts.

Player outcome

- Families experience a stable, trustworthy world with meaningful support and clear controls.

Build outcome

- Incident response, support tooling, legal readiness, load validation, analytics review and launch operations.

Dependencies: All intended launch systems, external specialist review and operational staffing.

- Closed family testing, then invitation beta, then controlled public opening.
- Independent child-safety, privacy and security assessment.
- Accessibility audit with users and assistive technology.
- Performance testing on low-end Android, iPad and common desktop browsers.
- Economy and reward exploit testing.
- Content review across age paths.
- Support, refund, deletion, incident and account-recovery procedures.
- Live event rehearsal and rollback.
- Clear launch scope; unfinished realms remain intentionally locked, not visibly broken.

Launch principle

A smaller complete world is safer and more magical than a large public site full of unfinished doors, placeholder stories and unreliable rewards.

SECTION 09

Cursor Production Contract

Make long AI coding runs precise, reviewable and difficult to misinterpret.

AI WORKFLOW

How Cursor Should Receive Work

Each phase needs a dedicated construction manual, not one endlessly growing prompt.

1. Attach this master PDF and the relevant detailed phase PDF.
2. Provide the current repository and explicitly identify existing architecture that must be preserved.
3. Attach approved reference images and character sheets as real files with stable names.
4. Tell Cursor to inspect the repository before changing it, then implement rather than merely propose.
5. Require it to generate or source every specified asset and reject placeholders.
6. Require testable checkpoints inside the phase, but let it continue through the complete assigned scope.
7. Require it to run builds, tests and visual checks at desktop, tablet and phone sizes.
8. Require a final implementation report listing files, routes, generated assets, known limitations and test results.
9. Review visually before beginning the next phase. Do not stack new prompts on a broken visual foundation.

Prompt discipline

Avoid vague requests such as “make it magical.” The phase PDF must define composition, asset layers, text, interactions, states, responsive behaviour, data and acceptance criteria screen by screen.

REUSABLE OUTLINE

Standard Detailed Phase PDF Structure

Every future phase manual should follow this order.

Section	Purpose
1. Phase objective	The exact player experience and build outcome.
2. Locked terminology	Names and concepts Cursor must use consistently.
3. Existing-system audit	What to inspect and preserve before coding.
4. User journeys	Every entry path, branch, interruption and return state.
5. Screen inventory	A numbered list of every page, modal, overlay and important state.
6. Screen-by-screen specification	Composition, copy, interaction, animation, responsive and accessibility details.
7. Image and asset plan	Every background, layer, character, object, icon, variation and exact prompt.
8. Component architecture	Routes, reusable components, services, state and folder structure.
9. Data model and permissions	Tables, fields, validation, ownership and audit requirements.
10. Content definitions	Dialogue, quest nodes, item data, configuration and age variants.
11. Testing plan	Functional, visual, accessibility, security, performance and edge cases.
12. Acceptance criteria	Unambiguous evidence required before the phase is complete.
13. Out-of-scope list	Features Cursor must not begin during this phase.
14. Final report format	What Cursor returns after implementation.

REUSABLE TEMPLATE

Screen Specification Template

Use this block for every important screen in a phase PDF.

Field	Required content
Screen ID	Stable code such as P1-S07.
Route/state	URL, modal, overlay or game state.
Player purpose	Why the player is here and what they should feel.
Entry conditions	How the screen is reached and required account/world state.
Visual composition	Foreground, background, characters, UI safe zones, lighting and focal order.
Exact copy	Headings, dialogue, labels, hints, errors and age variants.
Interactive elements	Buttons, hotspots, keyboard order, gestures and disabled states.
Animation/audio	Loops, transitions, sound cues and reduced-motion behaviour.
Responsive rules	Desktop, tablet, portrait phone and safe-area treatment.
Data reads/writes	State required and state changed.
Failure/edge states	Offline, slow asset, invalid state, expired session and recovery.
Assets	File names, dimensions, layers, prompts and references.
Acceptance evidence	Screenshots, tests and observed behaviours.

CODING CONTRACT

Cursor Implementation Rules

These instructions should be repeated in every production prompt.

- Do not return only a plan. Inspect, implement, run and fix.
- Preserve functioning existing systems unless the phase explicitly replaces them.
- Use reusable typed components and structured content rather than hard-coded copies of each page.
- Do not leave placeholder art, lorem ipsum, fake buttons or routes leading to empty pages.
- Generate assets to named files, optimise them and record generation prompts in metadata.
- Use real HTML for essential text and controls.
- Implement desktop, tablet and phone deliberately.
- Honour keyboard, focus, contrast, reduced motion and text scaling.
- Use server-side validation for rewards, guardian actions and account-sensitive operations.
- Run type checking, linting, unit tests and build.
- Add automated tests for the critical player journey.
- Document any limitation honestly rather than pretending it is complete.

Stop condition

Cursor should stop and report when a requirement is technically impossible with the available tools or would require unsafe assumptions. It should not silently replace the requirement with a placeholder.

PRODUCTION RECORDS

Image Asset Metadata

Every generated asset should be traceable and reproducible.

Recommended sidecar JSON

```
{
  "asset_id": "p1-homepage-background-v03",
  "file": "homepage-background-desktop-v03.webp",
  "screen_ids": ["P1-S01"],
  "asset_type": "background",
  "dimensions": {"width": 2560, "height": 1440},
  "source_file": "homepage-background-desktop-v03.png",
  "prompt": "[FULL GENERATION PROMPT]",
  "negative_requirements": ["no text", "no characters", "no windmill blades"],
  "references": ["visual-bible-v1.png", "homepage-approved-v02.png"],
  "status": "approved",
  "created_at": "YYYY-MM-DD",
  "notes": "Calm centre region reserved for menu. Mobile composition is separate."
}
```

Where a generation tool supports seed, model, style reference or source image identifiers, store them as additional fields. Never rely on a chat history as the only record of how a production asset was made.

SECTION 10

Appendices

Working terminology, writing rules and the immediate next documents to create.

GLOSSARY

Working Terminology

A shared language prevents prompt drift.

Term	Meaning
The World	The product and the fantasy universe.
Wayfinder	The player's in-world role.
Explorer	The player avatar.
Companion	The bonded original magical creature.
The Between	The connecting cosmic space/path network.
Heartstar	Recurring mysterious source/light.
Crossroads	Primary safe hub and player-home location.
Realm	A major themed world or region.
Scene	A clickable illustrated location or interior.
Hotspot	An accessible interactive region within a scene.
Echo	A collectible or phenomenon carrying traces of another place or time.
Starlight	Working name for special progress currency or energy earned through meaningful activity.
Home Quest	Optional guardian-approved real-world task.
Age path	Broad dialogue and support adaptation: Bright, Curious or Far Path.
Enterable picture	A scene that launches a walkable area or game.

NARRATIVE STYLE

Character Writing Rules

Warm, funny and honest without sounding like an adult pretending to be a child.

- Characters want things unrelated to teaching the player a lesson.
- Humour comes from personality and world logic, not cruelty or humiliation.
- Adults can be mistaken, apologetic, frightened, silly and still trustworthy.
- Children and young characters have agency and are not merely quest objects.
- Disabled characters are part of the world and have goals, skills and flaws beyond disability.
- Do not resolve every uncomfortable feeling immediately. Some stories can end with support and continued effort.
- Avoid therapy jargon in ordinary dialogue.
- Use honest, plain language when a safety message must be direct.
- Do not imply that kindness always produces immediate rewards.
- Recurring characters should remember meaningful help and also continue living when the player is absent.

Dialogue test

Read every line aloud. If it sounds like a worksheet, marketing copy or an adult delivering a disguised lecture, rewrite it.

MEASUREMENT

Initial Success Measures

The early goal is proof of affection and trust, not maximum scale.

Question	Evidence
Do players want to enter?	Homepage-to-start rate, qualitative reactions and visual usability.
Does onboarding create attachment?	Completion, companion selection confidence and return after first session.
Does the world feel understandable?	Navigation success, low confusion-related exits and support feedback.
Do children discover rather than merely follow?	Optional hotspot discovery and varied paths through the first realm.
Do families trust it?	Guardian linking completion, privacy understanding and low purchase/support friction.
Does it work across devices?	Comparable completion and satisfaction on desktop, phone and iPad.
Are values invisible enough?	Players discuss characters and outcomes rather than describing the game as a lesson.
Can the team expand it?	Time and defect rate required to add a new scene, quest, item or game.

Do not optimise too early

A small group loving the first realm is more valuable than a large group briefly sampling an unfinished universe.

RISK REGISTER

Primary Risks and Countermeasures

The biggest risks are creative inconsistency, uncontrolled scope and premature child-facing launch.

Risk	Countermeasure
AI-art inconsistency	Use approved sheets, asset metadata, review gates and a small recurring cast before bulk generation.
Too much world, too little depth	Complete Crossroads and Backwards Town before opening many realm doors.
Educational tone overwhelms magic	Review stories first as entertainment; remove explicit praise labels and summaries.
Guardian feature becomes coercive	Keep Home Quests optional, capped and separate from core story access.
Economy inflation or exploits	Append-only ledger, server validation, caps, simulations and correction tools.
Mobile experience feels cropped	Generate intentional mobile compositions and test lower-end devices.
Child privacy failure	Minimise data, separate roles, specialist review and automated permission testing.
Monetisation erodes trust	No loot boxes, no pay-to-win, guardian gates and transparent store design.
Cursor refactors destructively	Phase-scoped prompts, repository audit, tests, branches and review before the next phase.
Live event failure	Draft/preview, staged release, rollback, disable switches and reward correction.

NEXT ACTION

Immediate Next Documents

The master is complete; production should now move into focused phase manuals.

1. Phase 0 PDF: Visual Bible and Asset Pipeline - finalise style, characters, companion families, UI kit and generation workflow.
2. Phase 1 PDF: Your First Day - screen-by-screen construction manual from homepage through the first Crossroads invitation.
3. Phase 2 PDF: Crossroads and Player Home - hub, inventory, room, map, dailies and first collections.
4. Phase 3 PDF: Backwards Town - the complete flagship realm, including every scene, character, quest, shop and initial game.
5. Dedicated Safety and Guardian Technical Specification - detailed permissions, consent, email approvals, data retention and review requirements before Home Quests are built.
6. Mini-Game SDK Specification - created immediately before Phase 6 after the main world shell and economy are stable.

Recommended next build document

Create Phase 0 first, even if the homepage prototype already exists. It will establish the consistency system needed to generate dozens or hundreds of assets without the world visually falling apart.

CLOSING

Final Statement

The technology should disappear behind the feeling.

The World does not need to simulate every footstep to feel enormous. It needs places worth imagining, characters worth remembering, games worth replaying and small secrets that make a child believe the world continues when the screen is closed.

Its originality comes from the combination: a cosmic hidden structure, warm storybook fantasy, illustrated click-through exploration, occasional enterable pictures, companions shaped by the journey, honest values, optional guardian-approved real-world quests and a deliberate refusal to expose children to open social harm.

The first objective is not to build thousands of pages. It is to build one opening journey and one town so convincingly that the player believes thousands of pages could exist.

The north star

Create the place a child cannot wait to return to.

